

Frequently asked questions

Macquarie Coal Complex Transformation Precinct

July 2026

This document answers frequently asked questions about the Macquarie Coal Complex Transformation Precinct Master Plan and Rezoning Proposal currently on exhibition.

What is Post Mining Land Use?

The Macquarie Coal Complex Transformation Precinct (the Precinct) is part of a broader Mine Land Reuse initiative supported by Federal, State and Local Governments, aiming to deliver improved economic and employment outcomes on former mine sites. It responds to the Parliamentary Inquiry into Beneficial and Productive Post-Mining Land Use, particularly Recommendations 1 and 6, which call for legislative reform that will enable the successful transformation of former mining land to new employment uses.

In July 2025 the NSW Government committed to undertake a pilot project at the Macquarie Coal Complex in Lake Macquarie Local Government Area to demonstrate how alternative post-mining land uses can deliver opportunities for the region through coordinated relinquishment and redevelopment of former mining land.

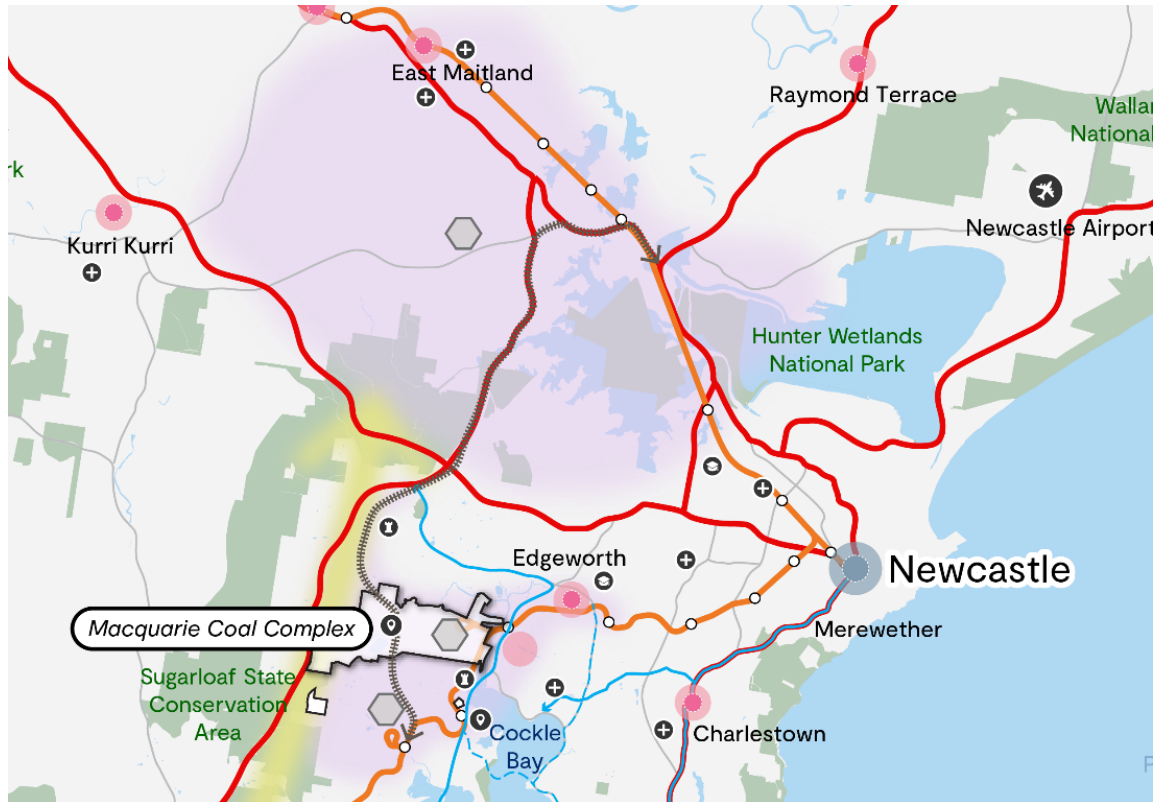
Lake Macquarie City Council (Council) were allocated \$2.5M in funding from the Federal Government's Net Zero Economy Authority (NZEA) with in-kind support from the State Government to undertake a master planning process for the Precinct.

The Precinct is led through a collaborative partnership between Department of Planning, Housing and Infrastructure (the Department), NZEA, local government and industry. This collaboration between all three levels of government and the private sector represents one of the most significant examples of early, coordinated post mining land use planning in NSW.

Where is the site located?

Located on Awabakal Country within the Lake Macquarie Local Government Area, the Precinct comprises approximately 1160 hectares of land across the suburbs of Teralba, Killingworth, Wakefield, and Barnsley. The Precinct forms part of the Lower Hunter region and is strategically

positioned within an established industrial and infrastructure corridor, with proximity to key regional centres.



Macquarie Coal Complex Transformation Precinct location

What is the planning framework?

Master Plan

The Department has worked in collaboration with Council, the NZEA and Glencore to prepare a Master Plan that will support the coordinated transformation of the Precinct from mining to employment generating land uses.

The Master Plan outlines an integrated vision for the Precinct, providing a staged approach and adaptive solutions to allow for the socio-economic shift toward a more diverse and sustainable regional future.

The Master Plan will help plan for the future of the region as industries change, ensuring Lake Macquarie remains a strong, resilient and connected community.

Explanation of Intended Effect (rezoning proposal)

The Department has also prepared an Explanation of Intended Effects (rezoning proposal) that supports the Master Plan and seeks to rezone land to catalyse development.

The rezoning proposal sets out proposed amendments to the *Lake Macquarie Local Environmental Plan 2014*, *State Environmental Planning Policy (Precincts-Regional) 2021* and *State Environmental Planning Policy (Planning Systems) 2021* to facilitate the rezoning of land in the Precinct.

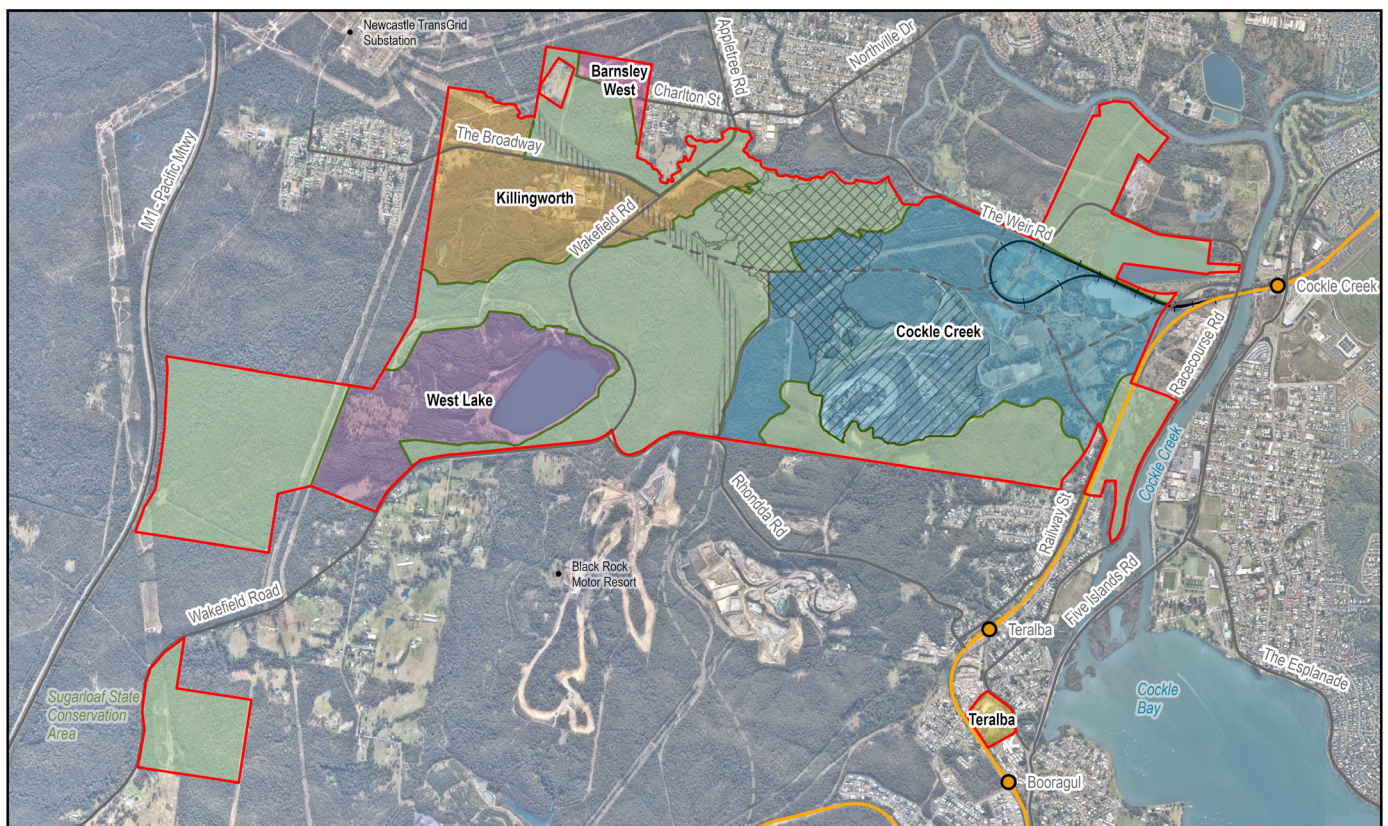
The rezoning proposal will enable delivery of:

- At least 500 hectares of developable land
- up to 1,130 new jobs
- around 36 hectares of new open space
- improved local roads and active transport options, such as new walking and cycling connections
- opportunities for recreation and tourism uses

The rezoning represents the first stages of realising the long-term vision of the Master Plan.

What is being planned for the Precinct?

The Master Plan organises the Precinct into character areas as shown in the below map:



Legend

- | | | |
|--|--|---|
| Precinct boundary | Environmentally constrained areas - further investigation required | Further investigation area - dam break inundation zone |
| ● Railway station | Barnsley West (light industrial) | Further investigation area - tailings storage facility |
| — Rail loop | Cockle Creek (employment) | Further investigation area - Lower Hunter Freight Corridor |
| — Railway line | Killingworth (employment) | |
| — Road | West Lake (mixed use) | |
| --- Road - potential | Teralba (residential) | |
| --- Indicative Lower Hunter Freight Corridor | | |

Macquarie Coal Complex character area map

The desired future land uses for the sub precincts are:

Cockle Creek - employment-generating uses, including general industrial, manufacturing, logistics, warehousing and freight-related uses.

Killingworth - light industrial, energy intensive uses, technology uses, small-medium employment uses and service commercial.

West Lake - the lake and surrounding landscape provide opportunities for walking and cycling trails, lookouts, water-based tourism facilities and heritage interpretation.

Barnsley West – curated mix of small-scale urban services, light industrial and complementary employment uses.

Teralba – opportunity for residential.

There may be other development opportunities identified during exhibition.

What are the environmentally constrained areas in the map?

The Master Plan includes a Structure Plan that identifies a large network of land as environmentally constrained land, where further investigation is required.

Environmentally constrained land is identified in the Master Plan as having biodiversity values or where natural features (watercourses, wetlands, steep slope, flooding) constrain development.

Future investigations will be required to consider the environmental and cultural outcomes identified in these areas for development potential.

How does the rezoning impact Glencore's rehabilitation obligations?

Glencore has ceased mining operations, with the site advancing through rehabilitation works in accordance with the approved Macquarie Coal Rehabilitation Management Plan (2022). Glencore will continue to meet their rehabilitation obligations – this process does not bypass their legislative requirements.

What type of development does the Master Plan envision?

The Master Plan will deliver a diverse range of uses across the Precincts, complemented by recreation, tourism, community and other development uses that deliver broader public value and economic growth.

The following employment is anticipated across the Precinct:

- General industrial
- Logistics and warehousing
- Light industrial
- Circular economy industries
- Renewable energy generation and storage
- Advanced industry and technology

Other development opportunities may be identified during exhibition.

The Precincts – Regional SEPP will require the Master Plan to be considered in the assessment of any development application within the Precinct.

How will the Precinct be delivered?

The implementation and delivery of the Master Plan is intended to be sequenced over several decades, to allow the future land uses to evolve in alignment with development uptake. Delivery of supporting infrastructure is intended to be staged with development as it is implemented over time. For more information see Section 4 of the Master Plan.

How can I learn more about the proposal?

Attend one of our drop-in sessions to discuss the Master Plan and rezoning proposal with our team. No formal presentation will be given, so drop in any time during the session.

Date	Time	Location
Wednesday, 22 July	Anytime between 4 and 7pm	Hunter Sports Centre kaiyu nungkiliko 43 Stockland Dr, Glendale
Thursday, 23 July	Anytime between 10am and 1pm	Hunter Sports Centre kaiyu nungkiliko 43 Stockland Dr, Glendale

How can I have my say?

Community feedback received during exhibition helps shape the final plan. Submit your feedback at the NSW Planning Portal before 5pm on 11 August 2026.

<https://www.planningportal.nsw.gov.au/macquarie-coal-complex>



What happens next?

Feedback received during exhibition will inform the finalisation of the proposal.

The proposal is expected to be finalised in 2026.



Flow chart showing key project milestones.

Contact us

For more information contact 1300 305 695 or email post.mining@dphi.nsw.gov.au.